including being featured in the 2022 Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework. NbS harness nature and the power of healthy ecosystems to address societal challenges, support humans, and safeguard biodiversity. They have also been shown to be more effective than some tech-based measures, although they are no substitute for reducing greenhouse gas emissions.

Water, trees, and grazing

Examples of NbS include afforestation and reforestation plans; trees sequester carbon, stabilize slopes, prevent soil erosion and landslips, provide cooling shade in cities, and can boost biodiversity. On tropical coasts, planting mangroves reduces the impact of storms, and “rewetting” degraded peatlands can “lock in” large amounts of carbon. Restoring natural watercourses and preserving floodplains curbs the flow of runoff and reduce the flood risk. In some places, ecologists have reintroduced beavers, whose dam-building slows down rivers and creates habitat for aquatic organisms. Livestock can be used to graze grassland and keep it in good condition.

NbS are key to mitigating climate change and reversing ecosystem degradation, but their implementation must respect the rights, values, and knowledge of local communities and Indigenous peoples.

“Nature-based solutions address societal problems in ways that benefit both people and nature.”

British Ecological Society report

See also: Human devastation of Earth • Halting climate change • Halting biodiversity loss • Nature’s contributions to people